Cain & Abel, password cracking

In this exercise, I performed password cracking using Cain & Abel within a controlled lab environment. The process involved capturing password hashes, selecting an appropriate cracking method, and executing the attack to recover plaintext credentials. This demonstrates how weak passwords can be compromised using automated techniques and highlights the risks associated with poor credential security practices.

Cybersecurity-Portfolio: https://github.com/ingridsec/Projects

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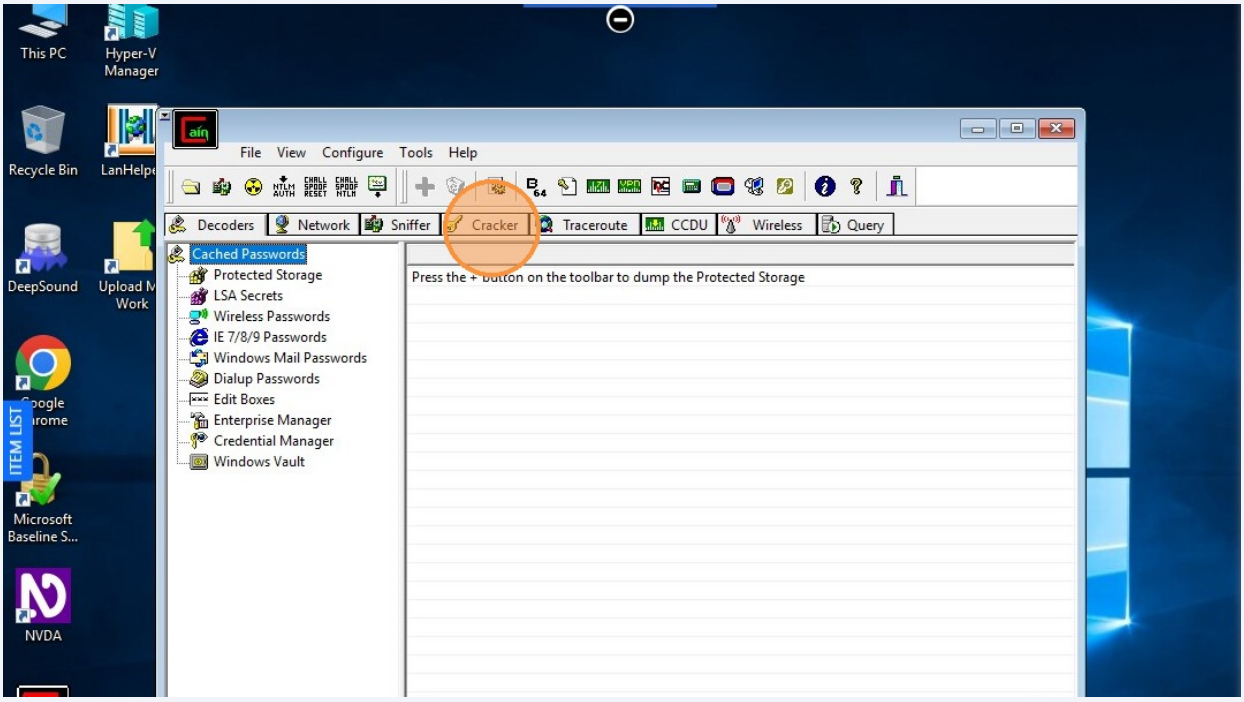
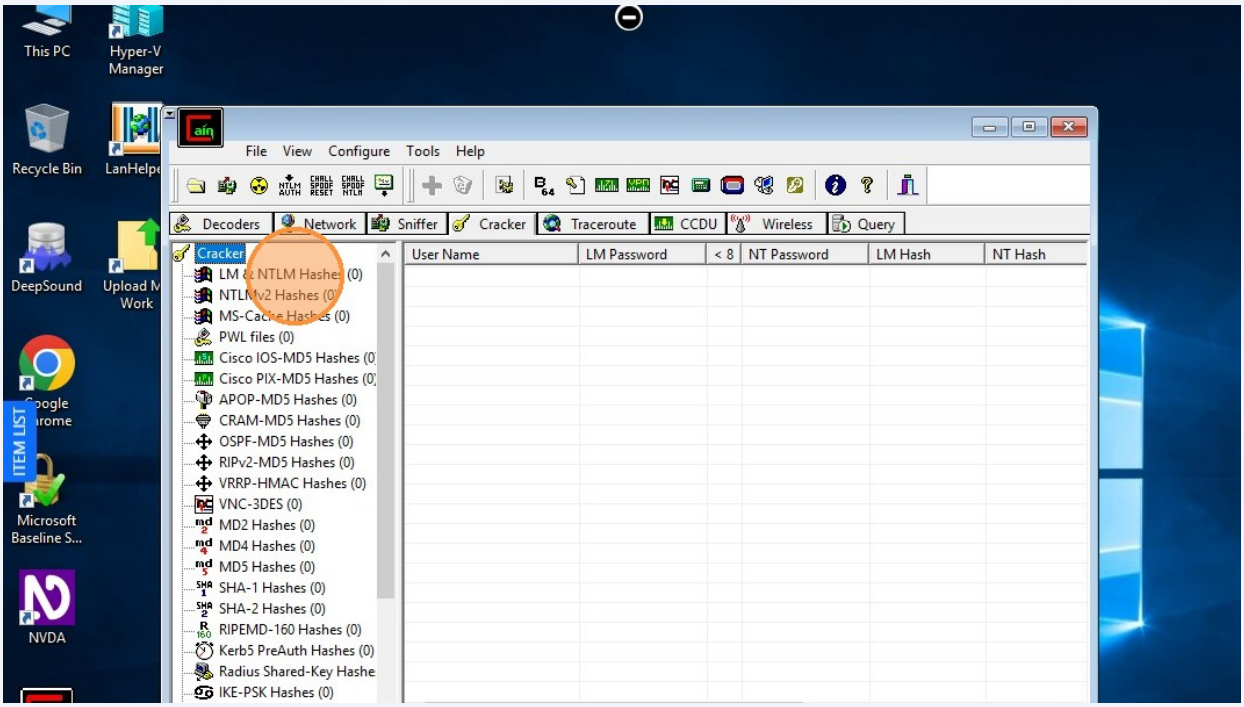
2 I navigated through the tool interface to access the password recovery module, where credential analysis and cracking operations are performed.



3 Select LM & NTLM Hashes.



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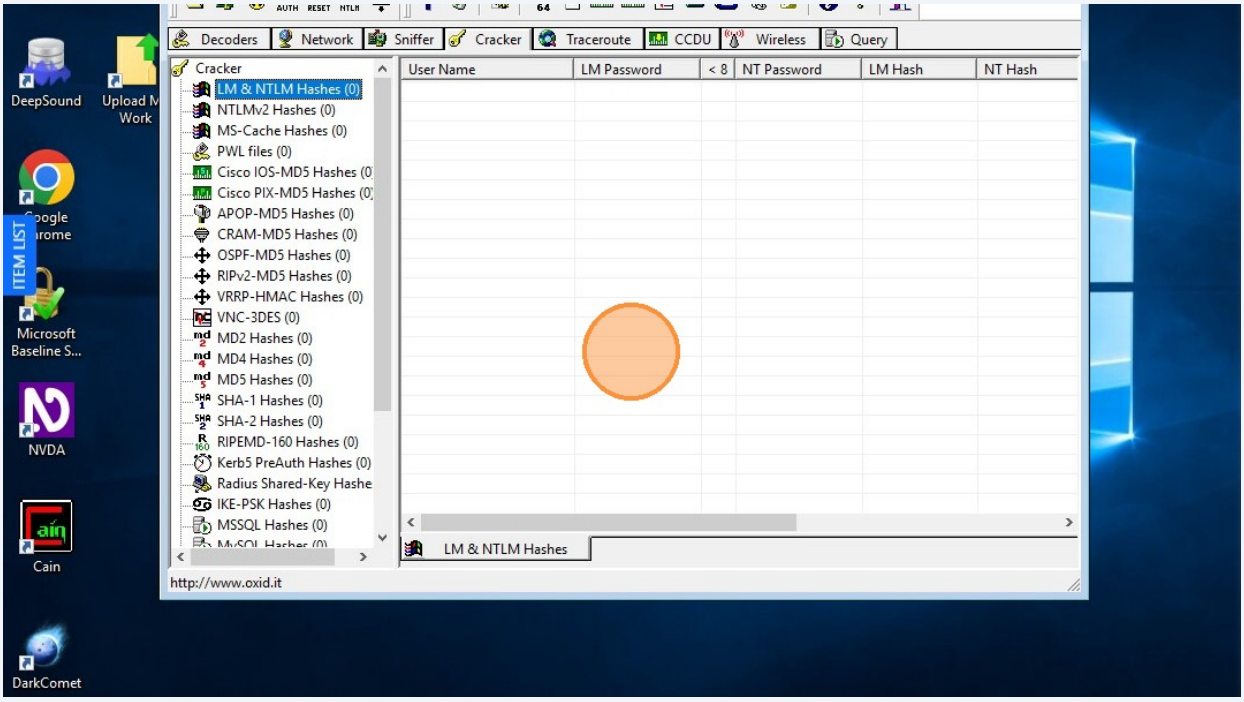

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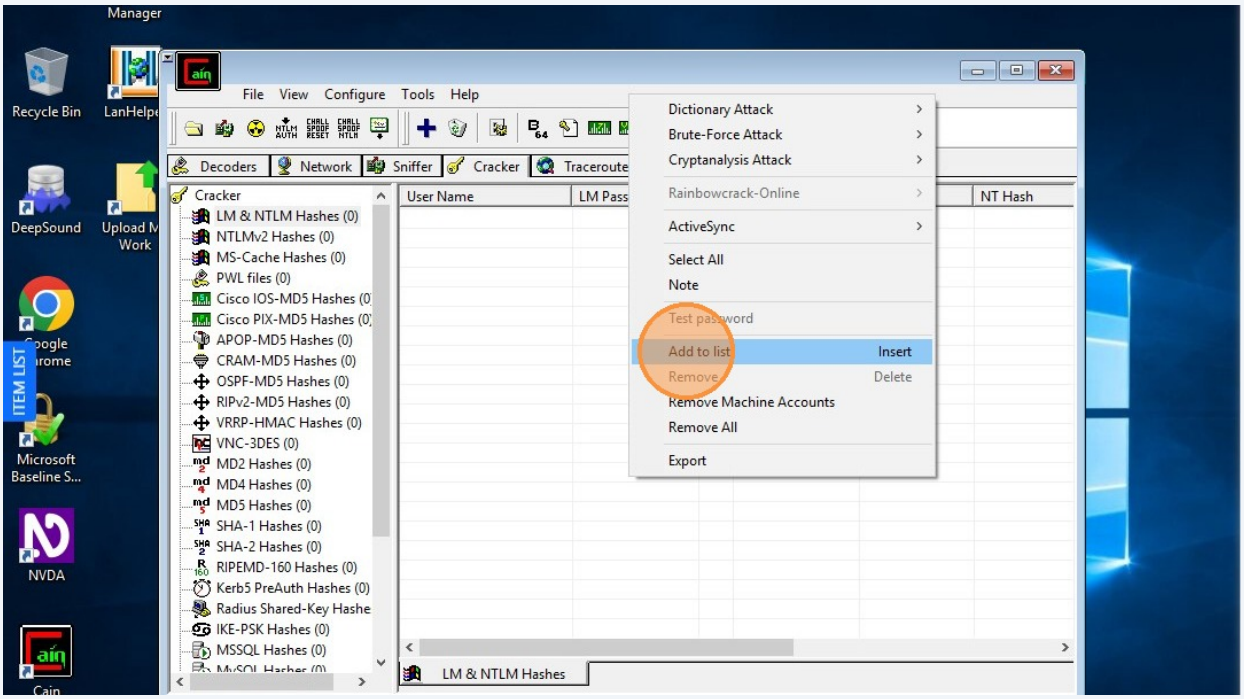

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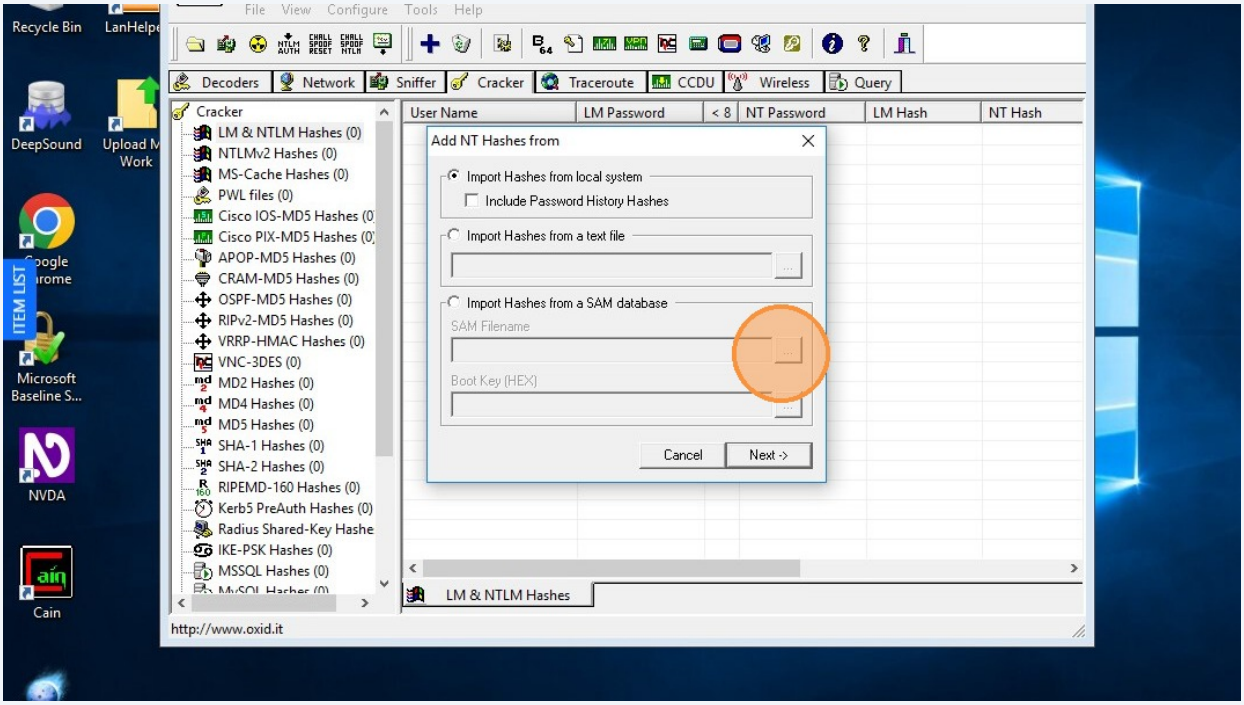

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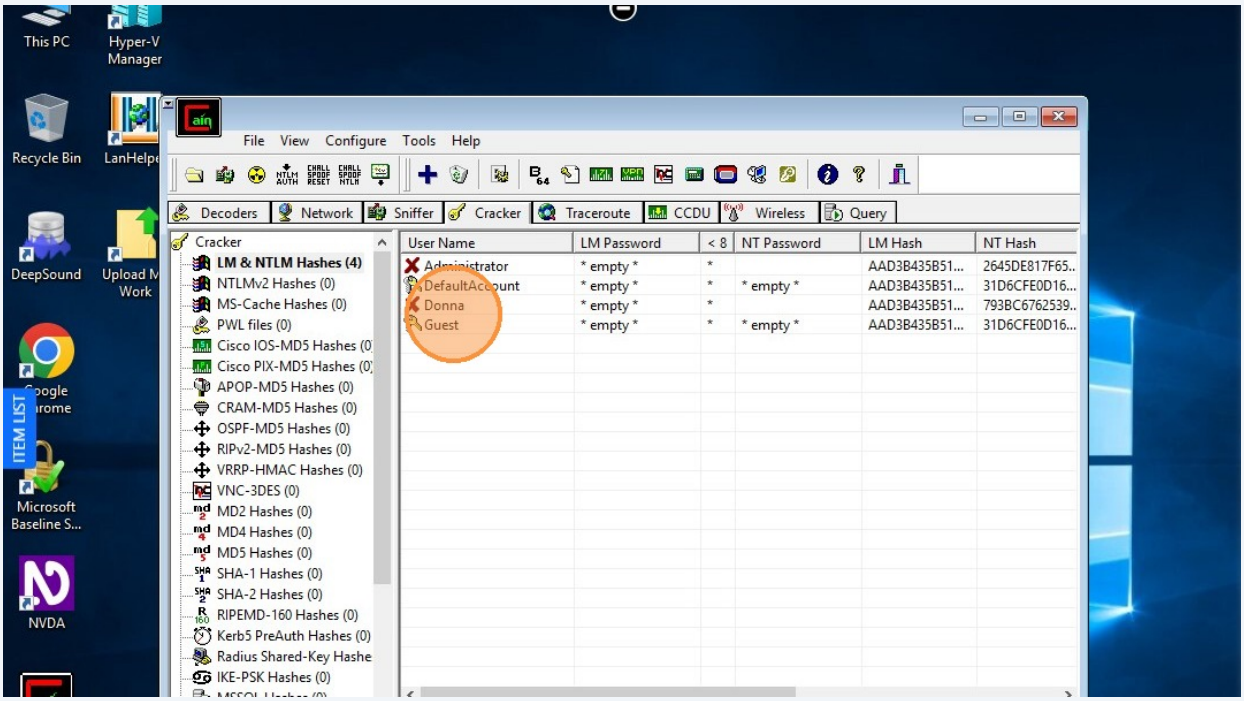

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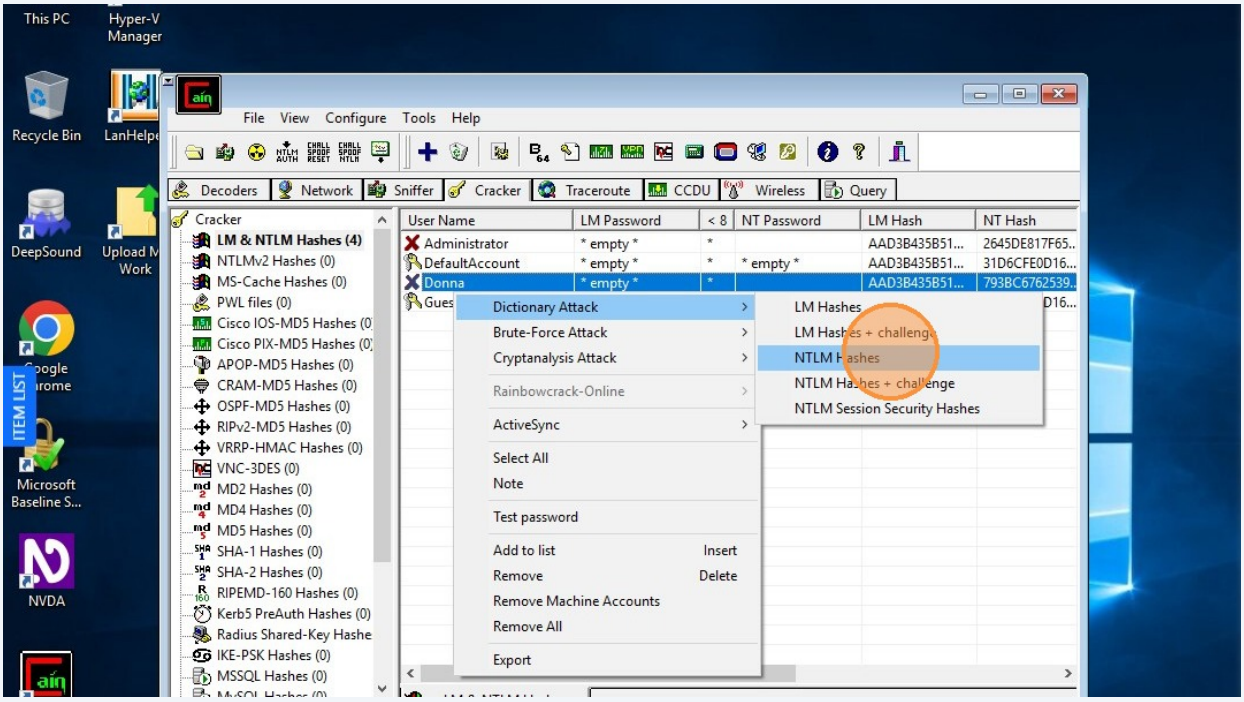

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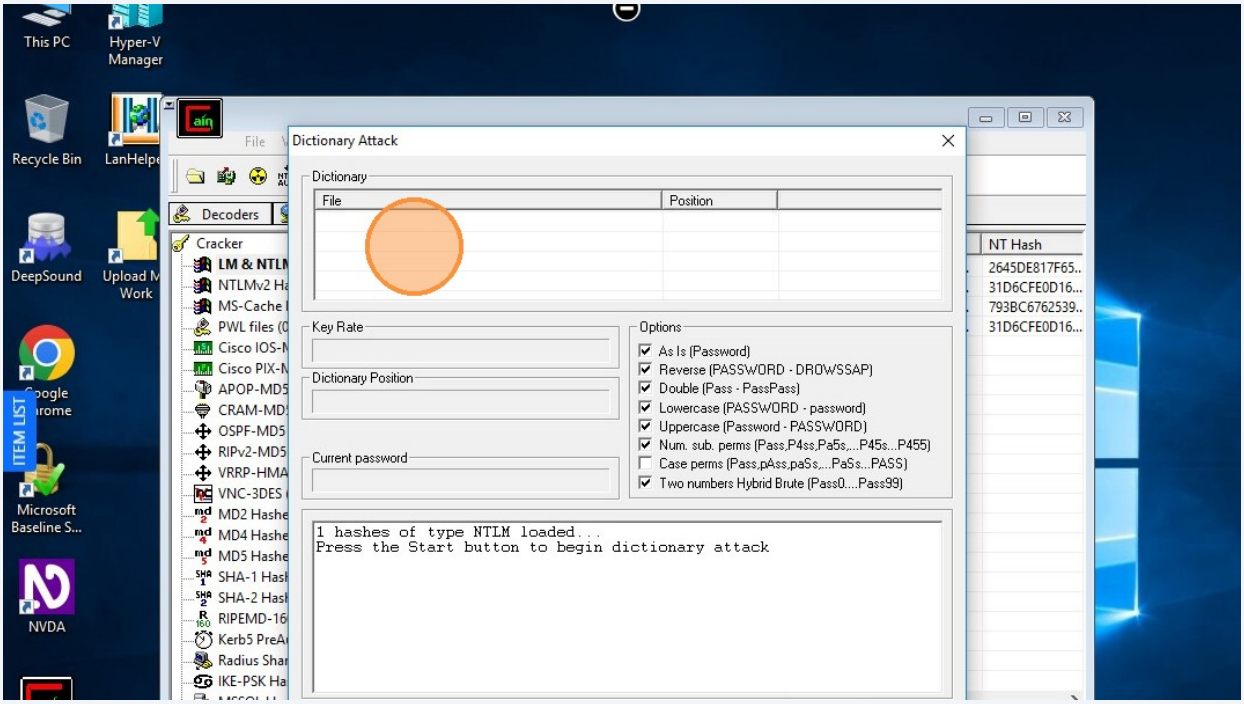

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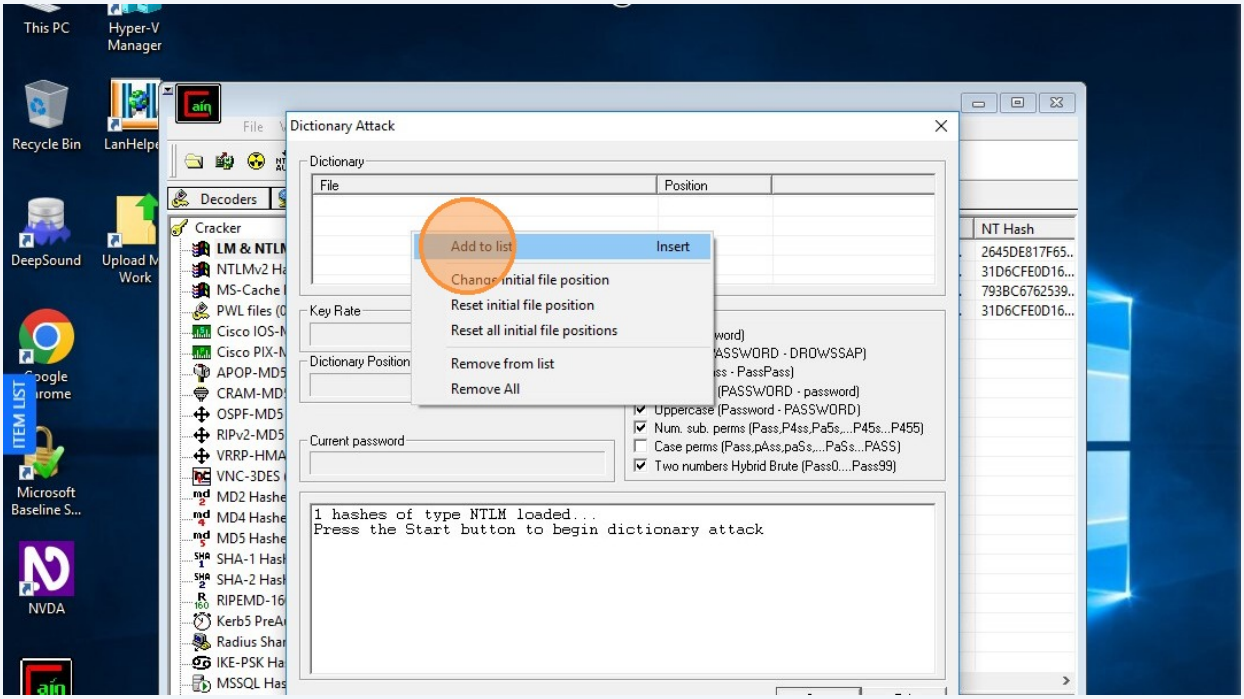

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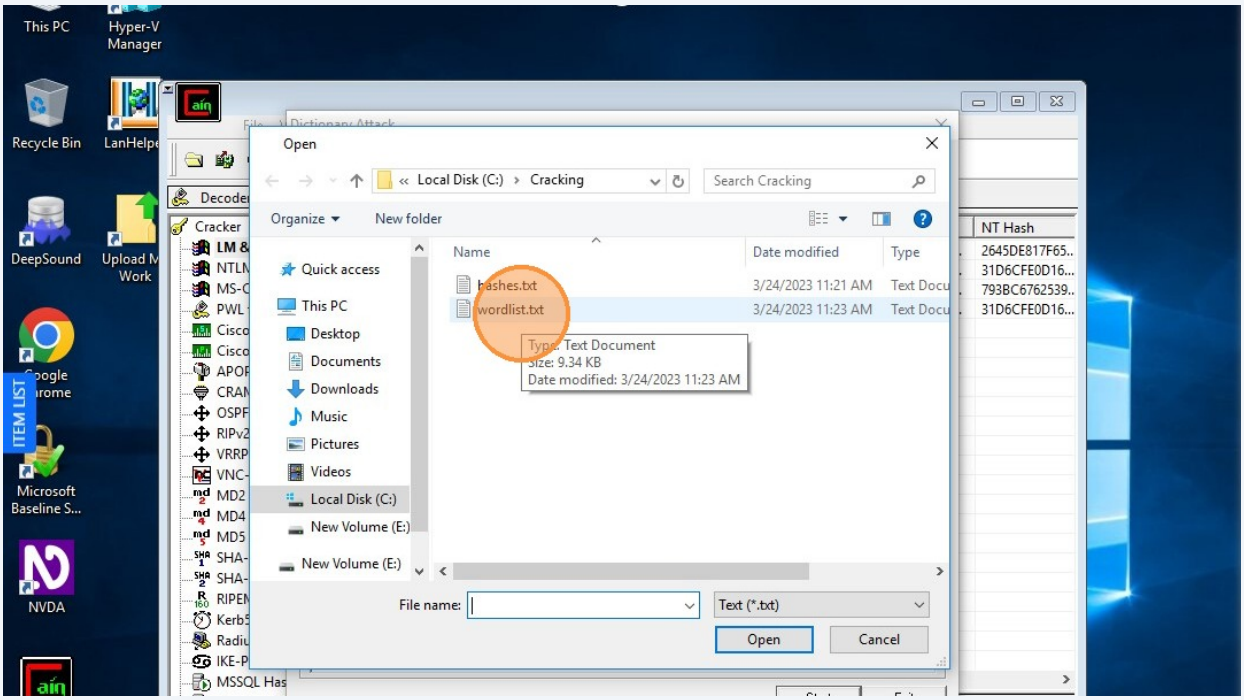

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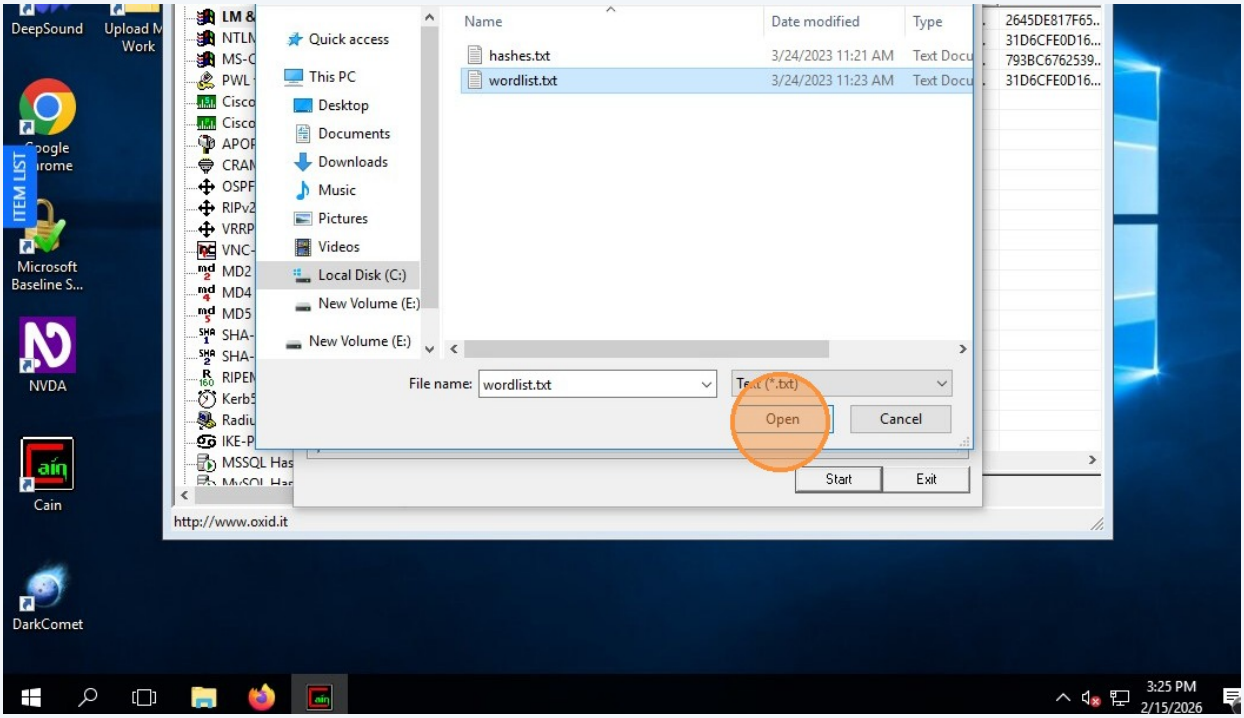

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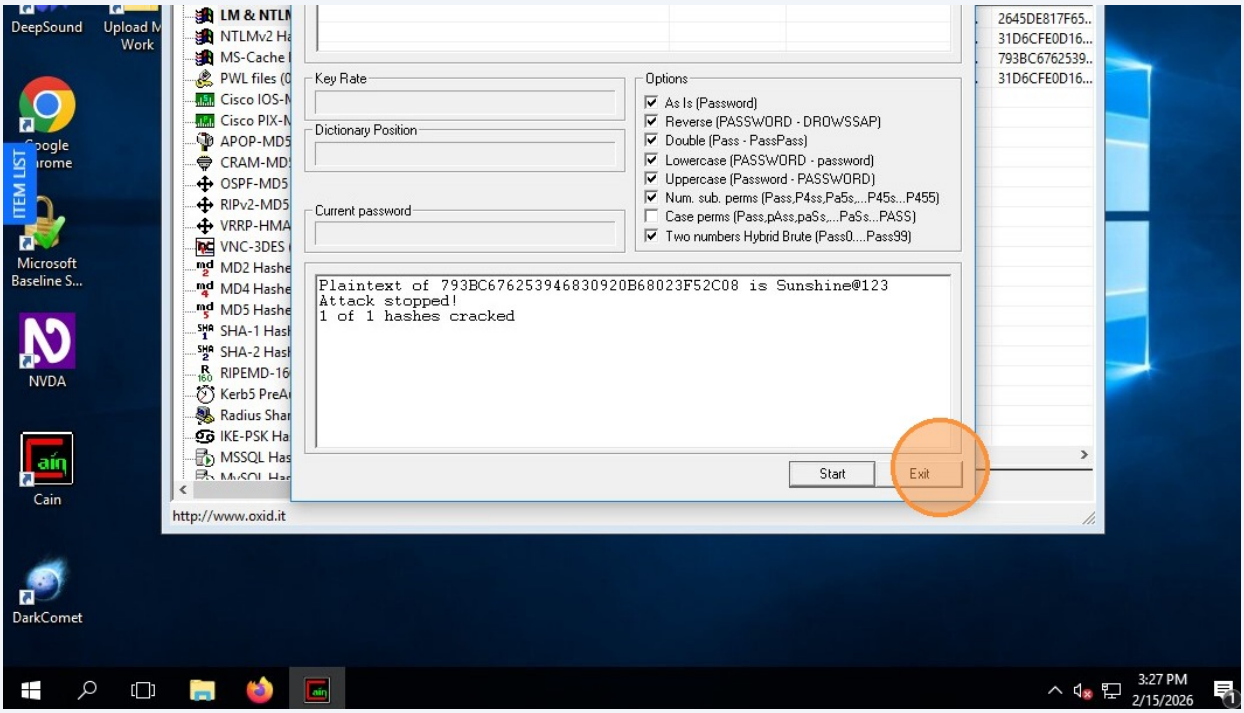

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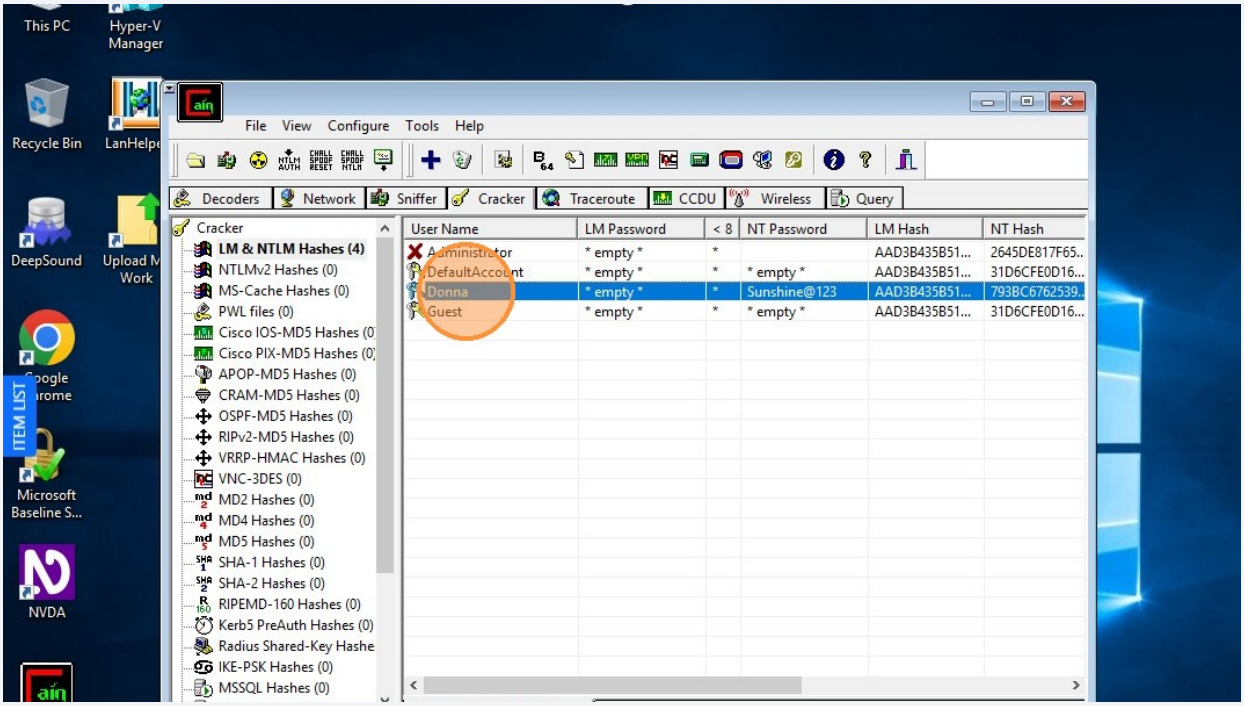

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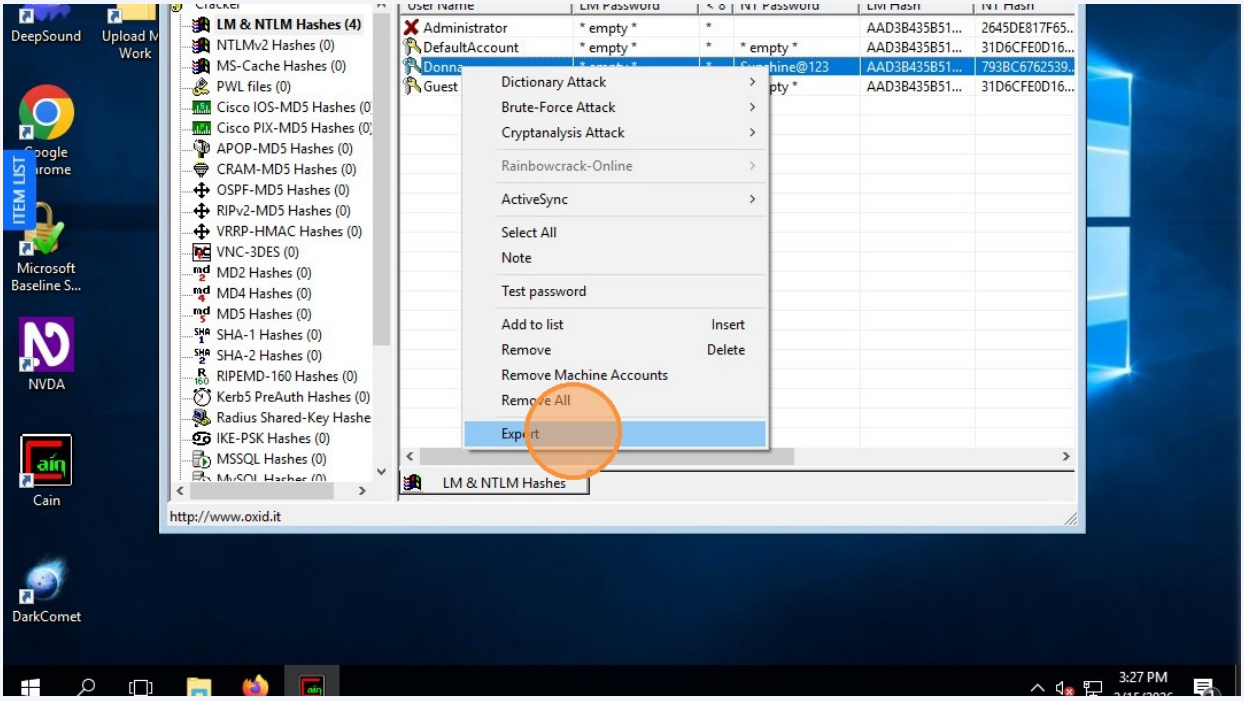

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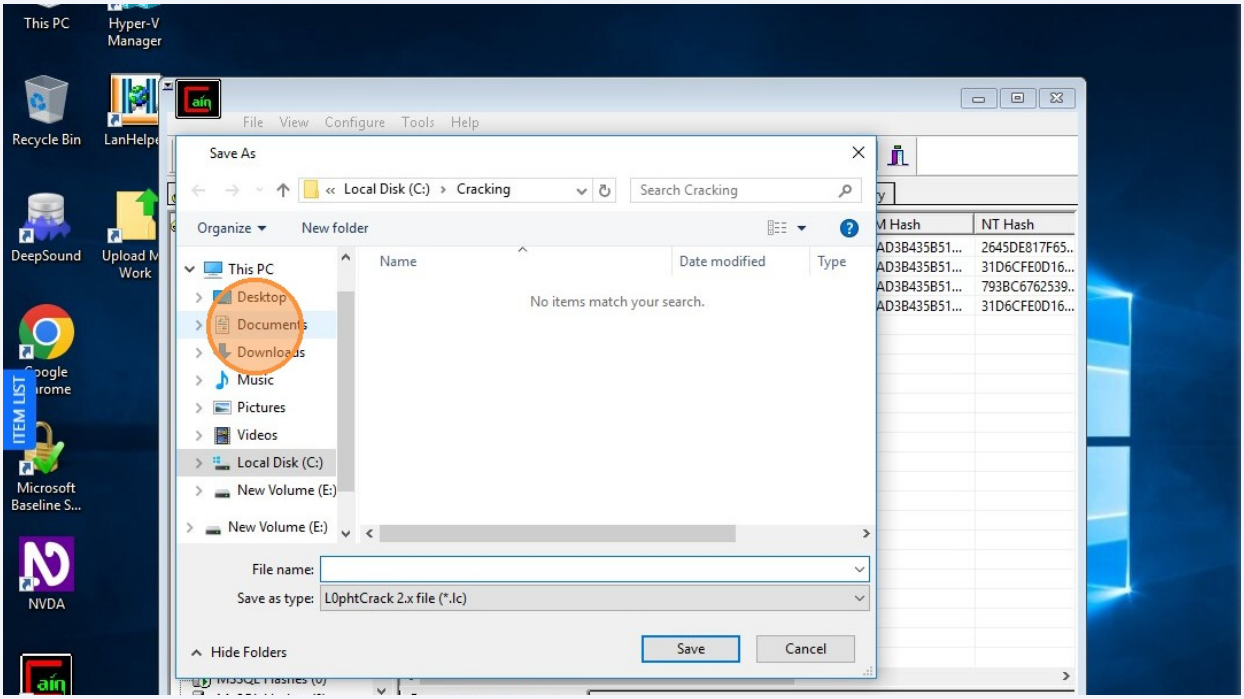

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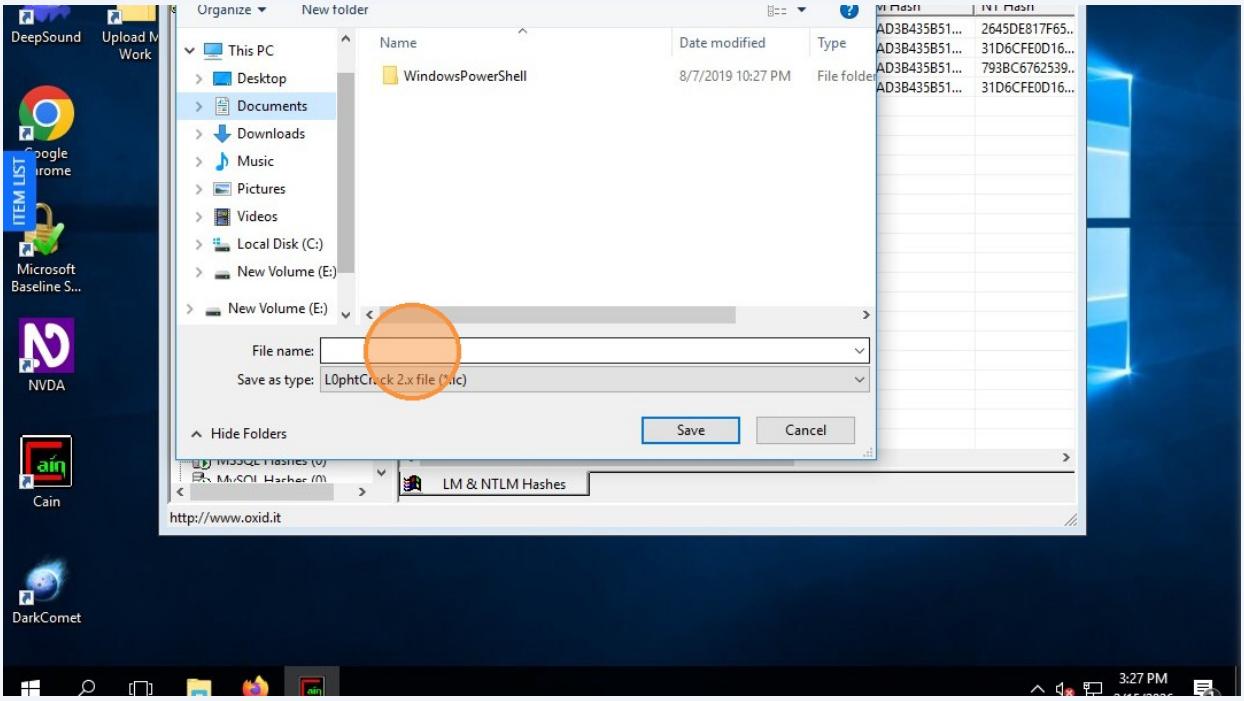

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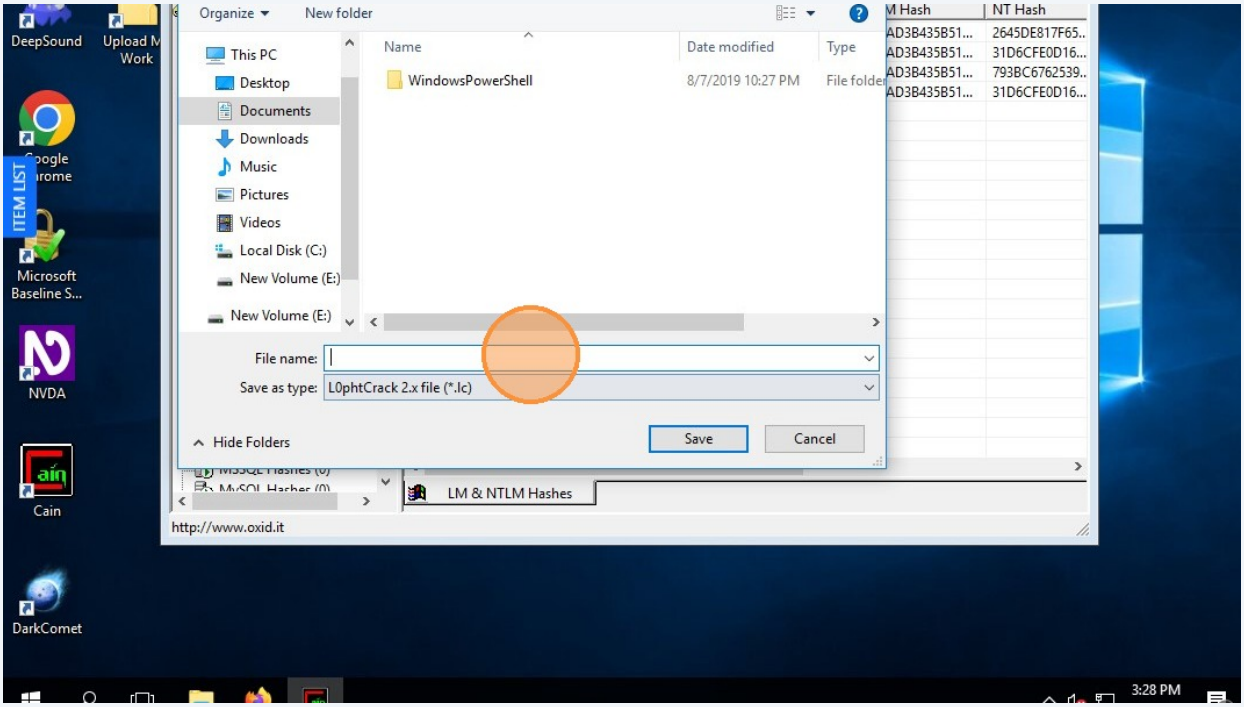

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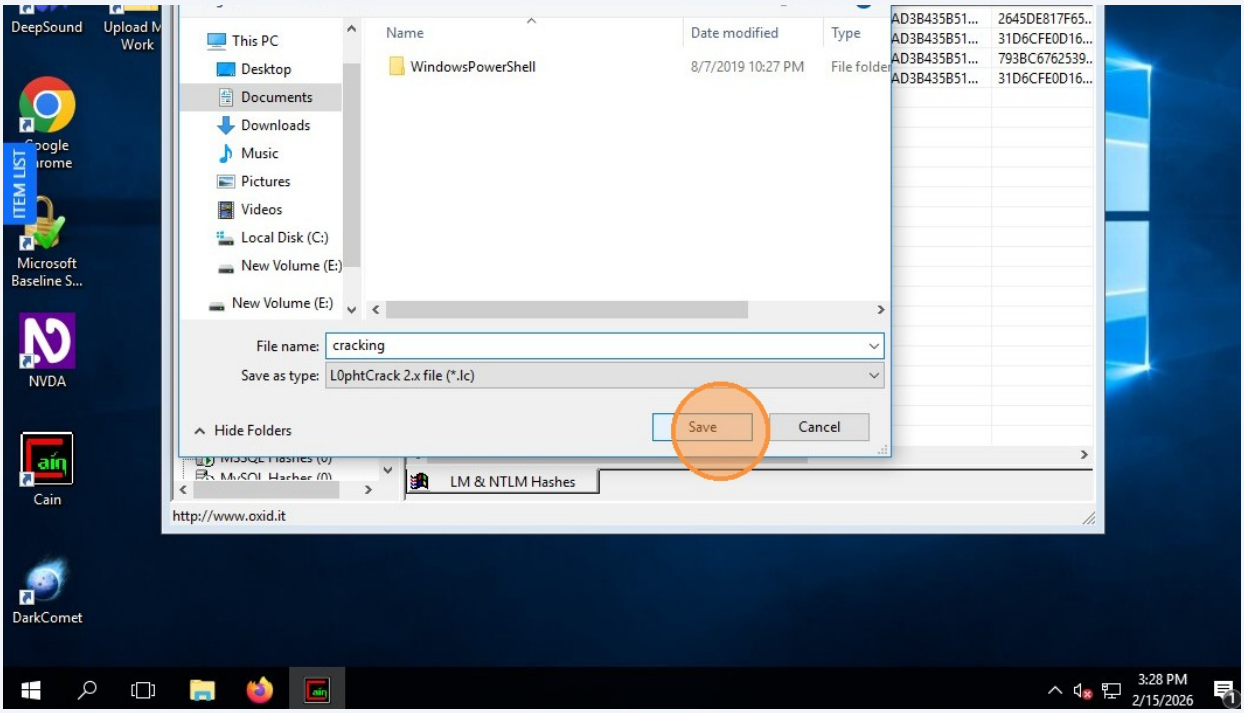

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Conclusion:
This project demonstrates how attackers can leverage password cracking techniques to compromise weak credentials. The successful recovery of plaintext passwords highlights the importance of enforcing strong password policies, implementing secure hashing mechanisms, and using additional protections such as multi-factor authentication. This reinforces the critical role of credential security in protecting systems against unauthorized access.

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Key Takeaway

This exercise highlights how easily weak passwords can be compromised using automated tools and common attack techniques such as dictionary and brute-force attacks. It emphasizes the importance of strong password complexity, secure hashing practices, and additional protections like multi-factor authentication. Understanding these risks is essential for identifying vulnerabilities and strengthening overall system security.